

BLAMO CLOSING

Automotive sales training

The 10 Steps of the Sale

A complete field guide to the car dealership sales process —
from the first handshake to the follow-up call.

Word-for-word scripts • what-to-say lines • common mistakes • checklists

Why the 10 Steps Work

This guide walks the entire journey a car buyer takes — from the first hello to the follow-up call weeks later. The steps work because they follow how real buyers actually decide: they buy from people they trust, cars they've experienced, and deals they understand. Each step has a job: Step 1 starts trust, Steps 2-4 build understanding, Steps 5-6 answer doubts, Step 7 finds the win-win, Step 8 makes it official, and Steps 9-10 turn a sale into a relationship and a referral.

Skip a step and the next one gets harder. A rushed greeting makes the needs conversation shallow. A skipped test-drive debrief makes the negotiation a guessing game. Taken together, the ten steps are a repeatable process that protects the customer's experience — and your results.

The process you're about to learn is the ten-step process the owner of Blamo Closing uses on the dealership floor. It's honest, it's practical, and it never asks you to pressure anyone.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

This is a working guide, not a performance to memorize. Read it once to see the whole process, then practice one step at a time: take the Step 1 checklist into your next greeting, the Step 3 talk track into your next walk-around. The scripts are starting points — replace the bracketed words with your customer's situation and your dealership's real offers.

One rule: never use a line that is untrue. A great car deal is clear, honest, and easy for the customer to say yes to — and easy for them to trust afterward.

That rule runs through every script in this guide: real features, real numbers, real availability. If you can't deliver it, don't promise it — a promise you can't keep is worth less than a straight answer.

The rep's job across all ten steps: help a real person make a decision they can feel good about. That means listening more than you talk, showing instead of telling, and never needing to win an argument to make a sale. When the customer trusts you, every step gets easier — and so does word of mouth.

WHAT'S INSIDE

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Every step includes the step's goal, the process in the owner's own words, word-for-word what-to-say lines, the common mistake to avoid, and a checklist to use before your next appointment. The last page is a quick-reference one-pager you can keep in your pocket.

YOUR FIRST WEEK — A PRACTICE PLAN

- ☐ Day 1: Read Steps 1-2. Write down two ice-breakers you're comfortable using and one confirm-back line.
- ☐ Day 2: Use the Step 1 checklist on every customer: greet warmly, read their pace, learn what brought them in.
- ☐ Day 3: Study Step 3's walk-around talk track. Walk one car front-to-back, saying one benefit per stop.
- ☐ Day 4: Plan and run one test drive with the Step 4 route and intro line. Afterwards, ask only "How did the drive feel?" and listen.
- ☐ Day 5: Practice the Step 6 objection responses out loud — start with the objection you hear most often.
- ☐ Day 6: Review Steps 7-8. Write down your negotiation range and commit to the paperwork walkthrough line.
- ☐ Day 7: Read Steps 9-10. Prepare a thank-you note template and schedule your first follow-up call.

1 Meet & Greet Customers

GOAL — Make a great first impression that starts trust and rapport — and learn what brought the customer in today.

THE PROCESS

Meeting and greeting customers is one of the basic steps of the automotive sales process. It sets the tone for everything that follows — it's all about making a great first impression. When you greet your customers warmly and with a genuine smile, you put the first brick toward building trust and rapport. Use comfortable body language to show that you're approachable. It's also important to adapt to their pace and mood: some customers appreciate a bit of small talk to break the ice, while others want to dive straight into talking about cars. Listening is just as important as talking here; pay attention to their cues and respond accordingly. Remember, the goal of the meet-and-greet isn't just to say hello. It's an opportunity to learn a bit about your customers — like what brought them in today and what they are looking for.

WHAT TO SAY

The welcome: "Hi there, welcome in! I'm [Your name]. How's your day going so far?"

Ice-breakers (read the room, pick one): "I saw you pulling in — were you checking out the [model] out front?" · "Good day for car shopping — easy drive over?"

If they want to get straight to business: "Absolutely, let's get to it. Are you looking for something specific today, or are you open to exploring?"

The learning opener: "Before we walk the lot, can I ask what brought you in today?"

The escort line: “Great — let's start over here. Walk with me.”

THE COMMON MISTAKE

Treating the greeting as a script to recite instead of reading the customer — talking too much and listening too little.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Greet them within seconds with a genuine smile (or a warm “I’ll be right with you” if you’re with someone)
- ☐ Read their pace: small talk first, or straight to cars
- ☐ Learn what brought them in and what they’re looking for
- ☐ Escort, don’t point — walk with them to the next step

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Before your next shift, write down two ice-breakers you’re comfortable using — then use them on your first three customers today.

2 Understand Customer's Needs

GOAL — Learn how the customer will actually use the vehicle so you can match the right car — not the one you want to sell.

THE PROCESS

To effectively understand your customer's needs, create a comfortable environment. Start with small talk to ease any tension and build rapport. Once they're at ease, shift to open-ended questions about their lifestyle, daily driving habits, and what they envision in a perfect car. For instance, ask, “How will you mainly use this vehicle?” or “What features are most important to you?” As you listen to their answers, note the priorities, such as safety, fuel efficiency, or technology features. This is one of the most proven sales steps to selling a car and can positively contribute to your sales cycle. Don't be afraid to ask follow-up questions to clarify or delve deeper — like, “Can you share more about your must-have features?” This way, you get a full understanding of their objectives.

WHAT TO SAY

Openers: “How will you mainly use this vehicle?”

“What features are most important to you?”

“Tell me about a typical week of driving for you — what does that look like?”

“If you pictured the perfect car for your life right now, what would it have?”

Follow-ups: “Can you share more about your must-have features?”

“What are you driving now, and what do you love — or wish were different — about it?”

“Is safety, fuel efficiency, or technology the bigger priority for you?”

“How many people will usually ride with you?”

The confirm-back: “Let me make sure I've got this: you need [A], [B], and [C], and it'll mainly be used for [use]. Did I get that right?”

THE COMMON MISTAKE

Firing off questions like an interview and skipping the confirm-back — the customer leaves unsure you actually listened.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Find a comfortable spot; open, relaxed body language
- ☐ Ask open-ended questions about lifestyle and daily driving
- ☐ Note their priorities: safety, fuel efficiency, technology
- ☐ Follow up on must-haves to go deeper
- ☐ Confirm their needs back in your own words before moving on

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Run your next needs conversation using only open-ended questions, and finish with the confirm-back line.

3 Showcase Car Features

GOAL — Turn the customer's stated needs into real, tangible benefits they can see, touch, and try.

THE PROCESS

When you give your customers a detailed walk-around of your car's features, you highlight what makes it special. Start at the front, and as you circle around, open the doors to showcase the interior's comfort and tech features — like the touchscreen and climate control. Don't forget to pop the trunk and hood to discuss storage space and the engine's benefits. This is one of the most effective steps for selling a car, as it can give your customers a practical idea of the vehicle's features and help them decide based on real and tangible benefits.

WHAT TO SAY

Front: “Take a look at the front end on this one — it's got a look that stands out in a parking lot. And these headlights do a great job on dark roads.”

Interior (open the door): “Go ahead and take a seat. Feel how comfortable these seats are. This touchscreen is your control center — [show one thing]. And the climate control lets you and your passenger each set your own temperature.”

Trunk (pop it): “Now for the back. You mentioned [use case — hauling gear, road trips, kids' sports]. This is where that space pays off — see how the seats fold for even more room?”

Hood (pop it): “And under the hood — this engine is built for [daily commuting / towing / fuel economy]. [One honest benefit, in plain terms.]”

The tying line: “So everything you said was important — [need] and [need] — this car has you covered.”

THE COMMON MISTAKE

Reciting a spec sheet instead of connecting each feature to the needs the customer just told you about.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Start at the front and circle the car
- ☐ Open the doors: comfort and tech — touchscreen, climate control
- ☐ Pop the trunk: storage tied to their stated use
- ☐ Pop the hood: engine benefits in plain language
- ☐ Tie each feature back to their Step 2 answers
- ☐ Invite them to touch, sit in, and try everything

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Walk a car front-to-back right now and say one benefit per stop — each tied to a need a customer actually told you.

4 Conduct a Test Drive

GOAL — Let the customer experience the vehicle firsthand and leave feeling confident it fits their lifestyle.

THE PROCESS

Taking a customer on a test drive is an important part of the automotive sales process. It lets them experience the vehicle firsthand and imagine what owning it would be like. First, ensure the car is spotless and ready to go to make this step successful. Before hitting the road, remind the customer of the car's features that meet their needs and preferences. On the drive, keep the mood friendly and relaxed. Let them take the wheel and ask any questions they have. Offer helpful answers and guide them through different features, pointing out how the car handles and highlighting its comfort and technology. By the end of the drive, they should feel confident that this car fits their lifestyle. A well-conducted test drive shows off the vehicle and builds trust, helping the customer make a confident decision.

WHAT TO SAY

Intro before the road: "The car's all set for you — spotless, full of gas, mirrors adjusted. Remember the [feature] you liked? We'll feel it on the road."

Setting the route: "Here's the plan: I'll take us out to the main road so you can get the feel of it, then you take the wheel. We'll do a little highway and some side streets so you can feel how it handles."

In-car guidance: "Take this next turn at your normal speed — you'll feel how solid it is."

"Notice how quiet it is on the highway?"

"Try the [tech feature] when you get a chance — it's right at your fingertips."

"This is the acceleration you'd get merging onto the freeway."

Keep it relaxed: "No pressure — this is your time with the car. Ask anything as it comes to you."

THE COMMON MISTAKE

Talking through the whole drive and turning the customer into a passenger in their own test drive.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Car spotless, fueled, mirrors adjusted before they arrive
- ☐ Route planned: highway stretch plus side streets
- ☐ Customer drives; you guide — not the other way around
- ☐ Point out handling, comfort, and tech in real time
- ☐ Keep the mood friendly; answer every question
- ☐ Pull back onto the lot, not a far parking spot

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Plan tomorrow's test-drive route today: one highway stretch and two side streets — and say your intro line out loud once.

5 Review Test Drive Feedback

GOAL — Find out what they loved and what didn't meet expectations — so you can build momentum or fix concerns on the spot.

THE PROCESS

After a test drive, sit down with your customer and discuss how it went. This is your chance to understand what they loved about the car or what didn't meet their expectations. If they're excited, use that momentum to move toward closing the sale. If they raise concerns, address them directly by offering alternatives or clarifying any features they may have misunderstood. Keep the conversation friendly and ask questions like, "How did the drive feel?" or "Did you find the car comfortable?" Listen carefully, showing them you genuinely care about their needs. This builds trust and helps you understand what changes you need to make to close the deal.

WHAT TO SAY

"How did the drive feel?"

"Did you find the car comfortable?"

"What stood out to you most back there?"

"Was there anything that didn't quite meet your expectations?"

If they're excited: "It sounds like this one fits. What would you want to happen next to move forward?"

If they raise a concern: "Tell me more about that — what specifically didn't feel right?"

"Let's talk that through — there's usually a way to address it."

THE COMMON MISTAKE

Only listening for the "yes" and letting a real concern slide — it comes back at the negotiation or in the reviews.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Sit down face-to-face, no desk between you

- ☐ Ask open feedback questions and let them talk
- ☐ Note what they loved and what concerned them
- ☐ If excited, move toward the next step
- ☐ If concerned, address it directly with alternatives

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

After your next drive, sit the customer down and ask only “How did the drive feel?” — then listen without interrupting.

6 Address Customer's Objections

GOAL — Resolve the customer's real concerns with honesty and options — so they decide with confidence, not doubt.

THE PROCESS

After hearing how they felt about the test drive, it's time to address any concerns they might have. Listen closely and show that you understand where they're coming from. Address their objections clearly and remind them about the features they liked best. If they're hesitant about something, try to figure out the solution together. For example, discuss financing options or potential discounts if they're worried about the cost. If they have concerns about a specific feature, offer additional information or a demo to resolve their doubts. You can also offer to take them through past customer stories or a second test drive if needed to ease their concerns. Being supportive and understanding, you help them feel confident in their decision.

WHAT TO SAY

On price: “I hear you — this is a big purchase. Let's look at the numbers together and see what works. We can talk through financing options and what the payment would actually look like.”

On financing: “Let's get you a real answer. I can run the numbers through our financing partners and show you the options side by side — no obligation.”

On a feature: “That's fair. Let's look closer at that feature together — I can show you exactly how it works. And if this car isn't the right fit, we'll find the one that is.”

On “I want to think about it”: “Of course — you should feel good about this. Can I ask what's giving you pause? Sometimes talking it through helps. And whatever you decide, I'm happy to help.”

The rule that covers all four: listen fully → acknowledge in their words → address with facts or options → confirm. Never argue, never pressure, and never invent a discount that isn't real.

THE COMMON MISTAKE

Arguing or pushing past the objection — or inventing a “deal” you can't deliver. Both break trust.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Let them finish before you respond
- ☐ Acknowledge the concern in their own words
- ☐ Address it with facts, options, or a quick demo

- ☐ Remind them of the features they loved
- ☐ Offer real numbers or a second drive if it helps
- ☐ Never promise anything you can't deliver

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Pick the objection you hear most often and practice the acknowledge-then-address response out loud before your next appointment.

7 Flexible Negotiations

GOAL — Reach a deal both sides feel good about — a genuine win-win, not a battle.

THE PROCESS

In a new car sales process, leaving some room for flexible negotiations is smart. It isn't just about making a sale — it's also about ensuring that both you and your customer feel satisfied with the outcome. So, how do you keep room for negotiation? Before you begin the conversation, get an idea about the maximum discount or the range of perks (like free servicing, accessories, etc.) you can offer. During the negotiation, listen carefully to what the customer is saying. What are they focusing on? Is it just the price, or are there other factors like financing terms or extras that might sway them? It's one of the best car dealer tricks to steer the conversation towards something that looks like a compromise but ultimately is a win-win.

WHAT TO SAY

Know your range before you sit down: your maximum discount, your range of perks (free servicing, accessories, etc.), and the minimum you can accept.

Find what they actually care about: "Before we talk numbers — what matters most to you: the price, the monthly payment, your trade-in, or what's included?"

Trade value for value: "You mentioned [extras/financing] matters more than the price. What if we did [X] instead of [Y]?"

Win-win phrasing: "I want to find a number that works for both of us. Here's what I can do: [offer]. Does that work for you?"

"Let me check what I'm able to do on that — I'll come back with the best number I can."

"I can't go lower on the price, but I can add [perk]. Would that make this work for you?"

The ground rule: trade, don't just give — and never promise a discount or perk you haven't been authorized to offer.

THE COMMON MISTAKE

Starting with your best offer or giving ground without getting anything in return — you leave value on the table and the customer still feels pressured.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Set your discount range and perk list before the conversation
- ☐ Ask what matters most: price, payment, trade-in, extras
- ☐ Listen for what they're focusing on

- ☐ Trade value for value; move toward the win-win
- ☐ Never promise an unauthorized discount or perk
- ☐ End with a clear agreement both sides can point to

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Before your next deal, write down your maximum discount, your perk list, and your walk-away number — and stick to them.

8 Finalize the Paperwork

GOAL — Make the deal official with a paperwork walkthrough that's clear, honest, and free of confusion.

THE PROCESS

Finalizing and signing the paperwork is one of the most important steps in car sales. This is where the deal becomes official, and ownership of the car legally changes hands. When you reach this step, guide the customer through the paperwork carefully. Explain each document in simple terms and answer any questions they have. This step builds trust and clears up any confusion that could hinder the process. As you go through the paperwork, keep the conversation friendly and positive.

WHAT TO SAY

The kickoff: “We're at the final step — this is where the car officially becomes yours. I'll explain each document in plain terms as we go, so nothing's a surprise.”

The purchase agreement: “This lays out the price, your trade-in, and the total. Take your time reading it — I'll walk you through each line.”

The financing contract: “This shows your monthly payment, the interest rate, and the number of payments. The numbers we agreed on should all be right here — let's check them together.”

The warranty and service docs: “Read through what's covered so you know exactly what you've got — I'm happy to explain any of it.”

Before each signature: “Before you sign — is there anything on this page you'd like me to explain differently? No silly questions here.”

THE COMMON MISTAKE

Rushing the customer through signatures to “get it done” — confusion at this step turns into cancellations and bad reviews.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Quiet, set-up desk; no rushing
- ☐ Explain each document in plain terms first
- ☐ Point out price, trade-in, payment, and rate
- ☐ Confirm they understand before every signature
- ☐ Keep it friendly and positive throughout
- ☐ Answer every question without judgment

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

At your next signing, read the financing contract line by line with the customer and point to the payment figure yourself.

9 Delivery

GOAL — Hand over the keys in a way that celebrates the purchase and starts the ownership experience right.

THE PROCESS

After all the paperwork is signed, it's time to hand over the keys and set up the car delivery. Find a time that works for your customer to pick up their new car and ensure it's a smooth experience. Greet them with a big smile, congratulate them, and maybe snap a quick photo to celebrate. Before they leave, give the car one last clean, put in a small thank you note for a gift, and answer any last questions they have.

WHAT TO SAY

The welcome: "Welcome back! Today's the day — let's get you into your new car."

The congratulations: "Congratulations! This one's officially yours. How does it feel?"

The walkthrough: "Let's take two minutes and go through everything so you feel at home in it — here's the seat adjustment, here's Bluetooth pairing, and here's the [feature] we talked about."

The keys: "And here are your keys. Take a minute and just sit in it — this is your car now."

The photo: "Mind if I snap a quick photo? It's a good day — worth remembering."

The thank-you note: "There's a little thank-you note in the glovebox from our team. We're glad you chose us."

The last question: "Any last questions before you drive off? My number's in the folder — call or text anytime."

THE COMMON MISTAKE

Handing over the keys with a wave and letting the customer discover everything themselves — a rushed delivery creates needless support calls.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Schedule a delivery time that works for them
- ☐ Car freshly cleaned; one last wipe-down
- ☐ Congratulate them warmly and take the photo
- ☐ Quick feature walkthrough: seats, pairing, basics
- ☐ Thank-you note placed in the car
- ☐ Answer last questions; leave your direct contact

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Prepare a thank-you note template today and keep five copies in your desk, so delivery is ready before the customer arrives.

10 Follow-up Post-Delivery

GOAL — Turn a one-time sale into a relationship — check in, solve small problems before they grow, and earn referrals.

THE PROCESS

After delivering a car, following up with your customer is key to building a strong relationship. A quick check-in shows you care about their overall experience, not just the sale. Here's why it's important: it makes sure they're happy with their new car and allows them to ask any questions now that they've spent some time with it. If any issues arise, a follow-up allows you to sort them out before they become bigger concerns. This can prevent negative reviews and encourage positive word-of-mouth. Give them a call a few days after the sale to see how they're enjoying the car and to answer any questions. Or, send a friendly email with maintenance tips and let them know they can always reach out for help. Keeping the conversation open and positive shows them you're there to support them beyond the purchase and also increases the word-of-mouth marketing that can increase car sales of your dealership.

WHAT TO SAY

Call script (3–5 days after delivery): “Hi [Name]! It's [You] from [Dealership]. I'm just checking in on you and the [make/model]. How are you liking it?”

“Any questions about the [feature], the pairing, or anything else that's come up?”

“How did the first few drives feel — everything living up to what you expected?”

“Remember: any question at all, call or text me directly. I'm here for you.”

If an issue comes up: “Let's get that sorted — bring it in and we'll take care of you.”

Email template: “Subject: How's the new [Make/Model] treating you, [Name]? ... I hope you're enjoying your new car! A few quick tips: keep up with the maintenance schedule in the owner's manual, check tire pressure monthly — especially as the weather changes — and if you ever notice anything unusual, bring it in early; catching small things is easier on the car and on you. If anything comes up, reach out anytime. Thanks again for choosing us, and enjoy the ride!”

THE COMMON MISTAKE

Never following up and disappearing after the sale — that's when small frustrations become one-star reviews.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Call or email within 3–5 days of delivery
- ☐ Ask how they're enjoying the car, and listen
- ☐ Offer to answer any questions
- ☐ Share maintenance tips
- ☐ Fix issues fast, before they grow
- ☐ Keep the door open for referrals and word-of-mouth

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Schedule the 3-5 day follow-up call at the moment of delivery — put it in your calendar before the customer leaves the lot.

The 10 Steps at a Glance

Keep this one-pager with you. In order, each step makes the next one easier.

1. Meet & Greet	Warm welcome, genuine smile; read their pace; learn what brought them in today.
2. Understand Needs	Open-ended questions — “How will you mainly use this vehicle?” — then confirm back.
3. Showcase Features	Walk-around: front → interior → trunk → hood, each feature tied to their needs.
4. Test Drive	Spotless car; customer drives, you guide; point out handling, comfort, tech.
5. Review Feedback	“How did the drive feel?” Build on what they loved; address concerns directly.
6. Address Objections	Listen, acknowledge, address with facts and options. Never argue or invent deals.
7. Negotiate	Know your range and perks; trade value for value; aim for the win-win.
8. Paperwork	Explain every document in plain terms; confirm understanding before each signature.
9. Delivery	Congratulate, walk them through the car, snap the photo, leave a thank-you note.
10. Follow-up	Call or email 3-5 days later; maintenance tips; be there beyond the sale.

WHERE TO GO NEXT

This guide covers the whole sale, from greeting to follow-up. More Blamo Closing products round out the training:

- The Sales Rep Starter Kit — five core closes, word-for-word scripts, and a pre-close readiness check. Use it with Step 6 and Step 7 when you're ready to ask for the decision.
- More guides on the way — new scripts and playbooks are added to the catalog as they ship.

One last reminder: none of these tools work better than a rep who listens. Run the ten steps in order, keep your promises, and treat every customer like someone you'd want to sell to again — because you will.

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